Pre-Discussion Research Submission Sheets (Task 2)

Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 2 • Mandatory Advance Submission

Discussion Topic: Should Companies Move to a 4-Day Working Week?

■ Candidate A: Constantin (Customer Service & Warehouse Focus)

Prepared Research Source: Retail & Warehouse Operational Experience

- Focus: Physical fatigue, manual handling, and customer coverage.
- Evidence: Warehouse staff walk 10-15 miles daily; 10-hour shifts increase strain and injuries.
- Concern: Squeezing 40 hours into 4 days leaves staff exhausted on their extra day off.
- Conclusion: 4-day week is beneficial only if daily hours are kept reasonable and rest days are rotated.

■ Candidate B: Thomas (Retail Assistant)

Prepared Research Source: UK 4-Day Week Pilot Trial Findings (61 Companies)

- Focus: Staff wellbeing, productivity, and reduced sickness.
- Evidence: Staff sick days dropped by 65% across 61 companies.
- Evidence: Company revenue increased by 1.4% on average; 92% kept the policy permanently.
- Conclusion: The '100:80:100' model (100% pay, 80% time, 100% output) works when meetings are streamlined.

■ Candidate C: Amara (Admin & Operations Assistant)

Prepared Research Source: Frontline Services & Family Impact Studies

- Focus: Childcare schedules, school runs, and essential service cover.
- Evidence: 8am-6pm days conflict directly with school pick-ups and affordable childcare.
- Evidence: Retail and healthcare cannot simply shut down on Fridays without losing trade.
- Conclusion: A compulsory 4-day week hurts parents; a flexible, optional model provides the best solution.